

- 14.** The concept of sustainable development relates to
 (a) consumption levels
 (b) exhaustible resources
 (c) social equity
 (d) intergenerational equity
- 15.** The mass nesting of the Olive Ridley sea turtles in India occurs at
 (a) Sunderbans
 (b) Gahirmatha marine sanctuary
 (c) Mangalajodi wetlands
 (d) Pulicat lake
- 16.** Which one of the following is not a part of India's National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC)?
 (a) National Mission on Sustainable Habitat
 (b) National Water Mission
 (c) National Mission on Pollution Control
 (d) National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture
- 17.** Wind erosion is one of the key causes of desertification and occurs when soil is left bare of vegetation. State the major cause of wind erosion in arid and semi-arid lands where this problem is most severe.
 (a) Cleaning of land for agriculture
 (b) Overgrazing by livestock
 (c) Deforestation
 (d) Forest fires
- 18.** A high Biological Oxygen Demand (BOD) value in aquatic environment is indicative of
 (a) a pollution free system
 (b) a highly polluted system due to excess of nutrients
 (c) a highly polluted system due to abundant heterotrophs
 (d) A highly pure water with abundant of autotrophs
- 19.** Genetic diversity in agricultural crops is threatened by
 (a) introduction of high yielding varieties
 (b) intensive use of fertilizers
 (c) extensive inter cropping
 (d) intensive use of bio-pesticides
- 20.** Consider the following statement(s) about wetland(s)
 1. It plays an important role in pollution abatement.
 2. It is a habitat of endangered and rare species of birds, animals, plants and insects.

3. It influence the micro-climate of the locality in addition to checking of underground salt water intrusion on an adjacent brackish water environment through interface pressure.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 3 (b) 2 and 3
 (c) Only 1 (d) All of these

- 21.** Which one of the following comes under the in-situ approaches of conserving biodiversity in India?

- (a) Sacred plants
 (b) Botanical gardens
 (c) Seed banks
 (d) Biosphere reserves

- 22.** The CERES principles are

- (a) codes for protection of salmon fisheries
 (b) a set of voluntary environmental standards for businesses
 (c) anti-pollution codes that were adopted at the first Earth Summit in 1992
 (d) designed to eliminate the production of greenhouse gases

- 23.** Among the following greenhouse gases, the emission of which one of the following is entirely anthropogenic?

- (a) Chlorofluorocarbons
 (b) Methane
 (c) Nitrous oxide
 (d) Hydrogen sulphide

- 24.** Environmental Kuznets curve

- (a) a semi-circle curve suggesting increase in per capita income increases the pollution
 (b) a U-shaped curve suggesting the level of development and carbon emission
 (c) suggest a U-shaped relationship between the carbon emission and ozone layer depletion
 (d) suggest a bell-shaped relationship between the concentration of certain pollution emission and per capita real GDP

- 25.** The 1987 Montreal Protocol was signed for which of the following reasons?

- (a) To phase out the use of CFC's, found to be causing depletion of the ozone layer
 (b) To ban nuclear testing in tropical oceans
 (c) Shifting from fossil fuel use to more renewable energy source to reduce the anthropogenic greenhouse effect
 (d) To stop the global trade in products made from endangered tigers

- 26.** Which among the following processes helps in evolution?

1. Natural selection
 2. Adaptation
 3. Mutation
 4. Reproductive isolation

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2, 3 and 4
 (c) 2 and 3 (d) All of these

- 27.** Match the following

List I	List II
A. Acid Rain	1. Nitrogen
B. Automobile Smoke	2. Carbon dioxide
C. Ozone Depletion	3. Nitrogen oxide
D. Global Warming	4. Oxide of sulphur
	5. Chlorofluorocarbon

Codes

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| A B C D | A B C D |
| (a) 4 2 5 3 | (b) 4 3 1 2 |
| (c) 4 3 5 2 | (d) 4 3 2 1 |

- 28.** Which of the following pairs is correctly matched of an endangered animal and a National Park?

- (a) Great Indian : Keoladeo National Park
 Bustard
 (b) Lion : Corbett National Park
 (c) Rhinoceros : Kaziranga National Park
 (d) Wild Ass : Dudhwa National Park

- 29.** Endosulfan, a pesticide which was banned by the Supreme Court of India, is listed under

- (a) Rotterdam convention
 (b) Stockholm convention
 (c) Bonn convention
 (d) Ramsar convention

- 30.** Black carbon has emerged as a major contributor to global climate change. In the context of it, consider the following statement(s)

1. Black carbon particles strongly absorb sunlight and give soot its black colour.
 2. It is produced both naturally and by human activities.
 3. Primary sources include emissions from diesel engines and cooking stoves.
 4. It remains in the atmosphere continuously for more than a month.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1, 3 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 3
 (c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) All of these

- 31.** The niche of an animal is best defined as
 (a) the number of individuals of the species, the environment will support
 (b) the same as its habitat
 (c) all the ways an animal fits into its environment
 (d) the specific part for which organism is best suited
- 32.** Biodiversity manifests itself at different diversities at following level
 1. Environmental diversity
 2. Species diversity
 3. Genetic diversity
 4. Ecosystem diversity
Select the correct answer using the codes given below.
 (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2, 3 and 4
 (c) 1 and 4 (d) All of these
- 33.** The use of micro-organism metabolism to remove pollutants such as oil spills the water bodies is known as
 (a) biomagnification (b) bioremediation
 (c) biomethanation (d) bioreduction
- 34.** Climate change may have an impact on the following
 (a) agriculture, natural terrestrial ecosystems and water resources
 (b) air quality, oceans and coastal zones
 (c) energy and human health
 (d) All of the above
- 35.** The effects of global warming are
 1. The sea level may rise.
 2. It will prevent the stirring up of the oceans.
 3. Fish population will migrate towards the Tropics.
 4. Precipitation will be frequent.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below.
 (a) 1, 2 and 4 (b) 1 and 3
 (c) 1 and 4 (d) All of these
- 36.** In India, we find mangoes with different flavours, colours, fibre-content, sugar content and even shelf-life. The large variation is on account of
 (a) species diversity
 (b) induced mutations
 (c) genetic diversity
 (d) hybridisation
- 37.** Biosphere reserves differ from national parks and wildlife sanctuaries because in the former

- (a) human beings are not allowed to enter
 (b) people are an integral part of the system
 (c) plants are paid greater attention than the animals
 (d) living organisms are brought from all over the world and preserved for posterity

- 38.** The broad objectives of the Ministry of Environment and Forest are
 1. afforestation and regeneration of degraded areas.
 2. prevention and control of pollution.
 3. protection of the environment.
 4. ensuring the welfare of the animals.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 2
 (c) 1 and 3 (d) All of these

- 39.** Due to their extensive rice cultivation, some regions may be contributing to global warming. To what possible reason/reasons is this attributable?
 1. The anaerobic conditions associated with rice cultivation cause the emission of methane.
 2. When nitrogen based fertilizers are used, nitrous oxide is emitted from the cultivated soil.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
 (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

- 40.** Hazardous waste is generated mainly by the industrial sector. It not only causes harm to the environment, but also leads to health problems. A small percentage of the hazardous waste is also generated in the house. One of the following is a hazardous waste that is generated in the house. Name it.
 (a) Paper
 (b) Leftover foodstuff
 (c) Old batteries
 (d) Plastic bags

- 41.** Municipal waste is disposed in the open dumps, landfills, sanitary landfills and is also burnt in large furnaces. This method is known as
 (a) incineration (b) blast furnace
 (c) waste furnace (d) All of these

- 42.** Which of the following wires are correctly matched?

Tiger Reserves	Locations
1. Udanti Sitanadi	: Rajasthan
2. Dandeli Anashi	: Chhattisgarh
3. Sariska	: Odisha
4. Satkosia	: Karnataka

Codes

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1, 2 and 4
 (c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) None of these

- 43.** The Access and Benefit Sharing (ABS) Protocol adopted by COP-10 at Nagoya is regarding the fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from the use of
 (a) the genetic resources of the Earth
 (b) Exclusive Economic Zones (EEZs)
 (c) marine and coastal areas significant for 'eco-tourism'
 (d) technology transfer mechanisms for Clean Energy Development

- 44.** Consider the following wetland(s)
 1. Point Calimere (Tamil Nadu)
 2. Sambar (Rajasthan)
 3. Loktak (Manipur)
 4. Harike (Punjab)

Which of the given above wetland(s) of India have been included in the International Ramsar Convention list?

- (a) Only 2 (b) 1, 2 and 3
 (c) 2 and 3 (d) All of these

- 45.** Which among the following are the major reasons behind preferring Eucalyptus tree in the planned forestation process?

1. Plantation grows very fast.
 2. Plantation makes the soil more fertile.
 3. Wood from Eucalyptus tree is easily converted into pulp for Paper Industry.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1 and 3
 (c) 2 and 3 (d) All of these

- 46.** The 'pond bloom' of blue-green algae which causes the death of fishes and cattles produces the toxin of
 (a) ammonia (b) hydroxylamine
 (c) carbohydrates (d) fatty acids

- 47.** A balanced ecosystem is one in which the
 (a) number of organisms at all levels are equals
 (b) amount of energy synthesised and utilised is equal
 (c) amount of biomass at all trophic levels is equal
 (d) organisms are interdependent on each other

48. Match the following

List I (Major Biomes)	List II (Physical Characteristics)
A. The Northern most of the Temperate Formations	1. Floristically poor (i.e. a continuous belt across North America and Northern Eurasia)
B. Arctic Tundra Vegetation	2. Boreal forest
C. Marine	3. Pelagic division
D. The Terrestrial Biomes of the Tropics	4. Savanna woodland
	5. Soviet steppe and North American prairie

Codes

A B C D	A B C D
(a) 2 4 3 1	(b) 2 1 3 4
(c) 4 3 5 2	(d) 4 1 3 2

49. The functioning of an ecosystem involves

- flow of energy and circulation of nutrients
- an increasing simplicity of relations
- increasing animal populations
- increasing number of trees and bushes etc

50. The term used for the conservation of ecosystems and natural habitats and the maintenance and recovery of viable populations of species in their natural surroundings is

- core conservation
- in-situ conservation
- ex-situ conservation
- peripheral conservation

51. Which of the following is not one of the major environment problems resulting from human interference in the nitrogen cycle?

- Eutrophication
- Nitrous oxide release increases global warming
- Increased acid rain
- Stratospheric ozone depletion

52. Atmospheric ozone layer, which protect us from UV-B and C is getting depleted most by addition of

- chlorofluorocarbon
- carbon monoxide
- carbon dioxide
- sulphur dioxide

53. Consider the following statement(s)

- National Parks are a special category of protected areas of land and sea coasts where people are an integral part of the system.

- Sanctuaries are concerned with conservation of the habitat of a particular species.

- Biosphere reserves are connected with the habitat of a particular wild animal.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- 1 and 3
- Only 2
- 1 and 2
- All of these

54. Which one of the following pairs of geographical areas show maximum biodiversity in our country?

- Sunderbans and Rann of Kutch
- Eastern Ghats and Paschim Banga
- Eastern Himalayas and Western Ghat
- Kerala and Punjab

55. The first research project programme, which focused on the El Nino-Southern Oscillation and its predictability was called

- Climate Variability and Predictability
- Global Energy and Water Cycle Experiment (GEWEX)
- Global Change and Terrestrial Ecosystem (GCTE)
- Tropical Ocean and Global Atmosphere (TOGA)

56. In which of the following the maximum plant diversity is found?

- Tropical evergreen forests
- Tropical moist deciduous forests
- Sub-tropical mountain forests
- Temperate moist forests

57. Consider the following characteristic(s), with reference to a freshwater lake

- Richness in nutrients.
- Rapid turnover of phytoplankton.
- Depletion of dissolved oxygen.

Which of the above is/are observed in a lake after its eutrophication?

- Only 1
- 1 and 2
- Only 3
- All of these

58. Which one of the following terms describes not only the physical space occupied by an organism, but also its functional role in the community of organisms?

- Ecotone
- Ecological niche
- Habitat
- Home range

59. Eutrophication of lakes is a consequential effect of the accumulation of

- silt load
- sewage
- nitrate and phosphates
- vegetation

60. India is party to

- United Nation Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC).
- Convention on Biological Diversity.
- Convention on Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals.
- Convention on World Heritage.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- 1 and 3
- 1 and 4
- 1, 2 and 4
- All of these

61. Which one of the following zones of the atmosphere is rich in ozone gas?

- Mesosphere
- Troposphere
- Stratosphere
- Ionosphere

62. Mangroves are salt-tolerant forest ecosystems. Name the largest mangrove forests in the world that constitute 7% of the world's mangroves, house a variety of wildlife sanctuaries and are also a potential site to harness tidal energy.

- The Sunderbans in Paschim Banga
- Musser forests in Ecuador
- The Mekong Delta in Vietnam
- None of the above

63. Name the gas released from landfills, decaying organic matter under shallow water in marshes and bogs, flooded paddy fields, by ruminant animals and termites and by the burning of biomass. A molecule of this gas has 21 times more global warming potential than a molecule of CO₂.

- Sulphur dioxide
- Methane
- Ammonia
- Nitrous oxide

64. Match the following

List I (Biosphere Reserves)	List II (Places)
A. Manas	1. Meghalaya
B. Pachmarhi	2. Assam
C. Nokrek	3. Madhya Pradesh
D. Achanakmar Amarkantak	4. Chhattisgarh

Codes

A B C D	A B C D
(a) 4 3 1 2	(b) 2 1 3 4
(c) 4 1 3 2	(d) 2 3 1 4

- 65.** Which of the following statement(s) regarding ozone layer within the atmosphere is/are correct?
1. It absorbs most of the ultraviolet radiation found in the Sun's rays.
 2. Chlorofluorocarbons are serious threat to the ozone layer.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

- 66.** Match the following

List I (Natural Vegetations of India)	List II (Annual Rainfall Received)
A. Tropical evergreen forests	1. 100-200 cm
B. Tropical deciduous forests	2. Above 200 cm
C. Tropical dry forests	3. Less than 50 cm
D. Arid forests	4. Above 300 cm
	5. 50-100 cm

Codes

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| A B C D | A B C D |
| (a) 1 2 5 3 | (b) 4 3 1 5 |
| (c) 2 1 5 3 | (d) 2 1 3 4 |

- 67.** Kanha National Park belongs to which one among the following bio-geographical areas in the world?

- (a) Tropical Sub-humid forests
(b) Tropical Humid forests
(c) Tropical Dry forests
(d) Tropical Moist forests

- 68.** Match the following

List I (Regions)	List II (Characteristic Vegetations)
A. Selvas	1. Mosses and lichens
B. Savanas	2. Epiphytes
C. Tundra	3. Tropophytes
D. Monsoon lands	4. Grasses and trees

Codes

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| A B C D | A B C D |
| (a) 3 1 4 2 | (b) 3 4 1 2 |
| (c) 2 4 1 3 | (d) 2 1 4 3 |

- 69.** Which one of the following is the correct sequence of the given tiger reserves of India from North to South?

- (a) Dudwa-Kanha-Indravati-Bandipur
(b) Kanha-Bandipur-Dudwa-Indravati
(c) Indravati-Kanha-Dudwa-Bandipur
(d) Dudwa-Kanha-Bandipur-Indravati

- 70.** Which one of the following statement(s) on biosphere reserves is not correct?

- (a) In 1973, UNESCO launched a worldwide programme on man and biosphere
(b) Biosphere reserves promote research on ecological conservation
(c) Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve is located in Madhya Pradesh
(d) Biosphere reserves are multipurpose protected areas to preserve the genetic diversity in ecosystems

- 71.** Consider the following statements

1. Jim Corbett National Park is the oldest National Park of India.
2. It was one of the nine Tiger Reserves created at the launch of the Project Tiger in 1973.
3. Initially it was named as 'Hailey National Park'.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2
(b) 1 and 3
(c) 2 and 3
(d) All of the above

QUESTIONS FROM CDS EXAM (2012-2016)

2012 (I)

- 1.** What is the major role of a greenhouse gas that contributes to temperature rise of the Earth's surface?

- (a) Transparent to both incoming sunlight and outgoing infrared radiation
(b) Stops both incoming sunlight and outgoing infrared radiation
(c) Lets outgoing infrared radiation pass through but stops incoming sunlight
(d) Lets incoming sunlight pass through but stops outgoing infrared radiation

- 2.** Which one among the following statements is not correct?

- (a) Trophic dynamics represents the transfer of energy from one trophic level to another in a food chain
(b) In deeper parts of oceans, primary production remains almost nil
(c) The primary consumers are called autotrophs
(d) The decomposers are called saprotrophs

- 3.** Over 90% of the world's biomass is in

- (a) tropical rain forests
(b) freshwater wetlands
(c) topsoils
(d) oceans

- 4.** Match the following

List I (Tiger Reserves)	List II (States)
A. Indravati	1. Karnataka
B. Periyar	2. Odisha
C. Simlipal	3. Kerala
D. Bandipur	4. Chhattisgarh

Codes

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| A B C D | A B C D |
| (a) 1 2 3 4 | (b) 1 3 2 4 |
| (c) 4 3 2 1 | (d) 4 2 3 1 |

- 5.** Which one among the following is a source of methane emission into the atmosphere?

- (a) Automobile exhaust fume
(b) Industrial chimney
(c) Mining
(d) Wetland

- 6.** Carbon dioxide is called a greenhouse gas because

- (a) its concentration remains always higher than other gases
(b) it is used in photosynthesis
(c) it absorbs infrared radiation
(d) it emits visible radiation

- 7.** Consider the following statements

1. Ozone is mostly found in the stratosphere.
2. Ozone layer lies 25 to 30 km above the surface of the Earth.
3. Ozone absorbs ultraviolet radiation from the Sun.
4. Ozone layer has no significance for life on the Earth.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2
(b) 1 and 3
(c) 2 and 3
(d) 3 and 4

- 8.** In wildlife conservation which one among the following best defines an 'endemic species'?
- When the critical number of a species declines in a forest due to parasitic attack
 - A species which is cosmopolitan and can be commonly found in biosphere
 - An endangered species which is found in a few restricted areas on the Earth
 - A species confined to a particular region and not found anywhere else

2012 (II)

- 9.** Match the following

List I (Biosphere Reserves)	List II (States)
A. Nilgiri	1. Odisha
B. Manas	2. Madhya Pradesh
C. Panchmarhi	3. Tamil Nadu
D. Simlipal	4. Assam

Codes

A B C D	A B C D
(a) 3 2 4 1	(b) 1 4 2 3
(c) 3 4 2 1	(d) 1 2 4 3

- 10.** The variability among living organisms from all sources including terrestrial, marine and other ecosystems and the ecological complexes of which they are part which includes diversity within species, between species of ecosystems refers to
- geographical diversity
 - zoological diversity
 - ecological diversity
 - biological diversity
- 11.** Ozone holes are more pronounced at the
- Equator
 - Tropic of Cancer
 - Tropic of Capricorn
 - Poles
- 12.** The variability among living organisms from all sources including terrestrial, marine and other ecosystems and the ecological complexes of which they are part which includes diversity within species, between species of ecosystems refers to
- geographical diversity
 - zoological diversity
 - ecological diversity
 - biological diversity

2013 (I)

- 13.** Which of the following statement(s) regarding recycling is/are correct?

- Recycling is just the collection and separation of the waste materials.
- Recycling is the collection and separation of the materials from the waste stream and their subsequent processing to produce a marketable product.
- Recycling leads to reduction of waste disposal cost.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- Only 1
- 1 and 2
- 2 and 3
- 1 and 3

- 14.** Which of the following gases in the atmosphere is/are responsible for acid rains?

- Oxides of sulphur
- Oxides of nitrogen
- Oxides of carbon

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- 1 and 2
- 1 and 3
- Only 2
- All of these

2013 (II)

- 15.** Which one among the following is responsible for formation of 'Ozone Holes' in the stratosphere?

- Benzopyrene
- Hydrocarbons
- Chloro fluoro carbons
- UV radiation

- 16.** Consider the following sanctuaries of India

- Periyar
- Dachigam
- Sariska
- Kanha

Which one among the following is the correct sequence of location of the above sanctuaries from South to North?

- 1, 4, 2, 3
- 4, 1, 3, 2
- 1, 4, 3, 2
- 3, 1, 4, 2

2014 (I)

- 17.** Which of the following method(s) is/are suitable for soil conservation in hilly region?

- Terracing and contour bunding
- Shifting cultivation
- Contour ploughing

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- 1 and 3
- Only 2
- Only 3
- All of these

- 18.** The vegetation type characterised by (i) a large expanse of grassland with scattered trees and shrubs, (ii) lying between tropical rain forest and tropical steppes and deserts and (iii) flat-topped trees, is called

- mid-latitude broad-leaf mixed forest
- temperate rain forest
- tropical savanna
- mid-latitude grassland

- 19.** Biodiversity is richer in

- tropical regions
- polar regions
- temperate regions
- oceans

2014 (II)

- 20.** The Equatorial region has no other season except summer. What could be the reason?

- The length of day and night is more or less equal over the year.
- The Earth's rotational velocity is maximum at the Equator.
- The Coriolis force is zero at the Equator.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- Only 1
- 1 and 2
- 2 and 3
- All of the above

2015 (I)

- 21.** Match the following

List I (Types of Grass)	List II (Countries)
A. Llanos	1. Australia
B. Prairies	2. Venezuela
C. Pampas	3. USA
D. Downs	4. Argentina

Codes

A B C D	A B C D
(a) 1 4 3 2	(b) 1 3 4 2
(c) 2 4 3 1	(d) 2 3 4 1

- 22.** Ozone layer of the Earth's atmosphere is important for living organisms because it
- prevents entry of ultra-violet rays
 - prevents entry of X-rays
 - maintains level of oxygen on the Earth
 - prevents acid rain on the Earth